vulcan club

HACK-O-LANTERN 2026

OFFICIAL RULES & REGULATIONS

Organized by Vulcan Club | Mirai School of Technology

01 TEAM FORMATION

- Each team must consist of **no more than 3 members**.
- All team members must be registered participants.
- Team composition cannot be changed once the hackathon begins without prior approval from the organizing committee.
- Each team must designate one team leader for communication with the organizers.

02 HACKATHON SCHEDULE

EVENT	DATE & TIME
Reporting & Entry	**7:00 PM, 31 October 2026**
Build / Development Begins	**8:00 PM, 31 October 2026**
Dinner	**12:00 AM, 1 November 2026**
Build / Development Ends	**8:00 AM, 1 November 2026**
Refreshments	**8:00 AM, 1 November 2026**
Final Judging Begins	**9:00 AM, 1 November 2026**

> **Official development period: 8:00 PM to 8:00 AM**

- The problem statement will be revealed during the opening ceremony.
- All development work must be completed within the allotted build time.
- Teams must submit their projects before the announced submission deadline.

- No further development or modification is permitted after the build period ends, unless explicitly allowed by the organizing committee.

03 CAMPUS ACCESS & RESTRICTED ZONES

A. Authorized Access Areas

Participants may access **ONLY** the following designated areas on the Mirai Floor:

- Designated classrooms allocated for the hackathon.
- Robotics Lab.
- Cluster area.
- Rooms in front of the Cluster, subject to availability and permission from Vulcan Club members.

Access to any additional rooms or facilities requires explicit approval from the organizing committee.

B. Refreshment Rooms: Strictly Supervised Access

- Entering refreshment rooms without prior consent and accompaniment from a Vulcan Club member is strictly prohibited.
- Permission must be obtained before entering these rooms, even for a short duration.
- These rooms have no CCTV surveillance, so access is strictly monitored and supervised by club members.
- Unauthorized entry will be treated as a serious violation of campus rules.

C. Strictly Restricted Areas: NO ENTRY

> **Off-limits to all participants: Mac Lab | Staffroom | Faculty & staff cabins | Any area not explicitly designated for Hack-O-Lantern**

Entry is strictly prohibited unless explicit authorization is obtained from the concerned campus authority.

D. General Campus Safety

- Participants must remain within the authorized Mirai Floor premises.
- Access to other floors and campus facilities is prohibited.
- Do not misuse or damage campus property, equipment, or infrastructure.
- Littering, vandalism, and disruptive behaviour are strictly prohibited.
- All instructions from campus security and organizing committee members must be followed.
- Violations of campus access restrictions may result in **immediate disqualification**.

04 PROJECT DEVELOPMENT

- Projects must be developed during the official build period.
- Previously completed projects cannot be submitted as the primary hackathon project.
- Existing libraries, frameworks, APIs, and open-source tools are permitted.
- Boilerplate code and starter templates are allowed.
- Teams must be able to explain and demonstrate their implementations.

- All development must stop at the end of the build period unless otherwise permitted by the organizing committee.

05 USE OF AI TOOLS

- AI tools such as ChatGPT, GitHub Copilot, Claude, and other AI coding assistants are permitted.
- Participants must understand the code generated or assisted by AI.
- Teams must be capable of explaining their implementations during evaluation.
- AI tools must not be used to plagiarize or reproduce another team's work.
- The use of AI does not exempt participants from responsibility for the originality, functionality, and security of their project.

06 CODE OF CONDUCT

- Plagiarism and copying another team's implementation are strictly prohibited.
- Teams must work independently.
- External individuals are not permitted to develop or contribute code to participating teams.
- Participants must be respectful towards organizers, mentors, judges, volunteers, and fellow participants.
- Harassment, misconduct, cheating, or deliberate disruption will not be tolerated.
- Violators may be removed from the event and/or disqualified.

07 LIVE LEADERBOARD & QUALIFICATION

- A live leaderboard will display participating teams' standings.
- Teams will be ranked according to the evaluation and scoring parameters announced by the organizing committee.
- Leaderboard standings will determine qualification for the final judging round.

> **ONLY THE TOP 10 TEAMS WILL QUALIFY FOR THE FINAL JUDGES' ROUND.**

- Teams outside the top 10 will not proceed to the final judging stage.
- All leaderboard scores are subject to verification by the organizing committee.
- Discrepancies or disputes must be reported to the organizers before the final qualification list is announced.

08 PROJECT SUBMISSION

Every team must submit its project before the announced submission deadline. Submissions must include:

- Project name and description.
- GitHub repository / source code link.
- Working prototype or demonstration.
- Brief explanation of the problem and proposed solution.

Late submissions may be rejected at the discretion of the organizing committee.

09 FINAL JUDGING

Only the top 10 qualifying teams will proceed to the final judges' round.

> **Final judging begins at 9:00 AM on 1 November 2026.**

Projects will be evaluated on:

Innovation	Originality and creativity of the idea.
Technical Implementation	Quality of development and technical execution.
Problem Solving	Effectiveness of the proposed solution.
Functionality	Working implementation and practical usability.
Presentation	Clarity of explanation and demonstration.

The judges' decisions regarding final rankings and winners will be final.

10 GENERAL RULES

- Participants must bring their own laptops and necessary accessories.
- Participants are responsible for their personal belongings.
- Dinner will be provided/served at the designated time of **12:00 AM**.
- Refreshments will be provided at **8:00 AM**.
- Food and refreshments must be consumed in designated areas.
- Participants must maintain cleanliness throughout the venue.
- Participants must not leave the designated event premises without informing an organizer.
- Any disputes must be brought to the organizing committee.
- The organizing committee reserves the right to modify or enforce rules when necessary.

11 FINAL AUTHORITY

The organizing committee reserves the right to disqualify any participant or team violating these rules and regulations.

All participants are expected to cooperate with the organizing committee, Vulcan Club members, campus security, mentors, and campus authorities.

CODE. CREATE. CELEBRATE.

HAPPY HACKING!